

ZHENGRUI CHENG

617-669-7091 | zc156@georgetown.edu | [LinkedIn](#) | [Personal Website](#) | [X/Twitter](#)

Washington, DC

EDUCATION

- **Georgetown University** Expected 2027
PhD in Economics Washington, DC
 - Recipient of Graduate Scholarship
- **University of Chicago, Harris School of Public Policy** June 2021
Master of Arts in Public Policy, Certificates in Research Methods & Financial Policy Chicago, IL
 - Recipient of Harris Merit Scholarship
- **Carnegie Mellon University** May 2019
Bachelor of Arts, Behavioral Economics, Policy and Organization Pittsburgh, PA
 - Minor in International Relations and Politics, and Economics
 - Graduated with University Honors; Member of Omicron Delta Epsilon Honor Society

PUBLICATIONS

- **Foreign Direct Investment, Trade Finance and Global Value Chain Integration** (2025)
with Xiang Ding and Marc Auboin. Chapter 6 in *Global Value Chain Development Report 2025: Rewiring GVCs in a Changing Global Economy*. [\[PDF\]](#)
Presentations: Global Value Chain Development Report 2025 Launch Event, Washington, DC; ADB-IDE-JETRO Joint GVC Webinar Series; Cambodia Anti-Corruption Unit Research Seminar.

SELECTED WORKING PAPERS AND WORK IN PROGRESS

- **Going Overseas: FDI Decisions and Supply Chain Integration** (2026) **Job Market Paper**
Sole-authored. Working paper, Georgetown University.
Presentations: AEA Annual Meeting, Trade and FDI session, Philadelphia (2026); Georgetown University Trade Lunch; AEA Annual Meeting, ODE Graduate Student Research Award Session, Washington, DC (scheduled, 2027).
- **Exporting Automation, Not Just Goods: Evidence from China's Industrial Robot Exports** (2026)
with Shiliang Cui and Lizhi Liu. [\[SSRN\]](#)
Reject and resubmit at *Manufacturing & Service Operations Management*.
Presentations: Georgetown University McDonough School of Business, PE Lunch; Washington University in St. Louis PE Workshop (scheduled).
- **Multinational Production and Domestic Value Capture: Cross-Country Evidence on Domestic Sourcing** (2026)
with Weining Xin (International Monetary Fund). Work in progress.
Presentations: IMF Asia and Pacific Department (APD) Seminar; AEA Annual Meeting Poster Session, Washington, DC, 2027 (scheduled).

RESEARCH AND POLICY EXPERIENCE

- **International Monetary Fund** Summer 2026
Fund Internship Program Intern, Asia and Pacific Department Washington, DC
 - Conducted research on multinational production, local supplier linkages, and domestic value capture across 80 economies and 41 sectors.
 - Integrated OECD ownership-split production accounts with productive-control and bilateral-position data to measure sourcing patterns and dynamic domestic value-added responses.

RESEARCH AND POLICY EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

- **University of Chicago & U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission** Mar 2021 – May 2021
Research Apprentice under Prof. Justin Marlowe and SEC Chicago, IL
 - Developed a municipal-bond climate-risk disclosure framework from evidence on treasury and corporate-bond disclosure mechanisms.
 - Presented recommendations to the U.S. SEC Office of Municipal Securities.
- **University of Chicago** Mar 2020 – Apr 2021
Research Apprentice under Prof. Christopher Berry Chicago, IL
 - Constructed a political-connection index by linking public-position and campaign-contribution records to property-tax data.
 - Analyzed tax-avoidance dynamics using network methods and Hamiltonian Monte Carlo.
- **Carnegie Mellon University and Deloitte Consulting** Jan 2019 – May 2019
Behavioral Economics Capstone Project Pittsburgh, PA
 - Led a five-person team developing a behavioral-economics guidebook and firm survey to support technology adoption at Deloitte.
 - Presented recommendations to senior management, including Deloitte’s Chief Data Scientist.
- **Harvard University, Department of Economics** Jul 2018 – Aug 2018
Research Assistant Cambridge, MA
 - Collected and transcribed source data into analysis-ready datasets, corrected anomalies in historical population data, and updated regression inputs for Chenzi Xu’s “Reshaping Global Trade: The Immediate and Long-Run Effects of Bank Failures” (*Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 2022).
- **United States Congress, House of Representatives** May 2017 – Jul 2017
Intern, Office of Congressman Danny K. Davis Washington, DC
 - Drafted constituent correspondence and policy memos on tax reform, poverty, reverse mortgages, and infrastructure.
 - Represented the office at hearings and researched employment policy for youth in foster care.

SKILLS

- **Software & Programming:** Python, R, Stata, L^AT_EX, Stan, Minitab